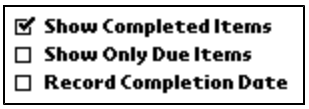
Palm OS Programming Recipes



Adding a checkbox to your form takes a minimal amount of work. Place it on your form such that the box is aligned with other checkboxes or input items. Usually the box is to the left of the text, but occasionally it will look better if it is right aligned (see for example the General Prefs panel in Palm OS 3.5.)

To use a checkbox, place one on your form in Constructor. You might want to make its bounding rectangle larger than necessary for the label, so that the user has a larger area to tap upon. Note that the checkbox is always vertically centered in the bounding rectangle and that the width is dynamically sized to be the exact width of the checkbox plus its label.

Some applications can set a checkbox's default starting value in Constructor, but most applications will need to set that value inside the handler for `frmOpenEvent`. Do this by calling either `FrmSetControlValue` or `CtlSetValue`, whichever is more convenient, to set the initial state of the checkbox to on or off.

When you want to read the value of the checkbox, call either `FrmGetControlValue` or `CtlGetValue`.

You will be sent a `ctlSelectEvent` when the user changes the value of a checkbox by tapping it. The event structure includes the control's ID, a pointer to the control, and the new value.

Checkboxes can have a group ID set, but doing so should be avoided. If the group ID is set, all checkboxes with the same group ID are mutually exclusive; turning one checkbox on turns off all other checkboxes in that group. If checkboxes are grouped, use `FrmGetControlGroupSelection` and `FrmSetControlGroupSelection` to retrieve and set the value. However, you really should avoid such a user interface because users do not expect this behavior from checkboxes. Instead, use push buttons or a pop-up list to ensure that only one item is selected.